

Matt Shade

AI ENGINEERING DIRECTOR | ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP | DESIGN
ENGINEERING

Hands-on engineering and design leader with deep experience building consumer platforms, scaling teams, modernizing digital products, and applying AI to real workflow problems.

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SELECTED IMPACT

- Strategically scaled high-performance, multidisciplinary engineering organizations, recruiting top-tier talent and management to accelerate enterprise subscription growth and execute critical digital platform delivery.
- Spearheaded a massive architectural consolidation of video infrastructure, synthesizing 8 disparate live and short-form video player integrations into 2 globally standardized systems, drastically reducing platform fragmentation and operational overhead.
- Orchestrated the strategic sunseting of a monolithic legacy application ecosystem, immediately capturing substantial cost savings and reclaiming extensive engineering bandwidth previously lost to technical debt and maintenance.
- Architected and deployed specialized GenAI agents designed to optimize critical newsroom operations, significantly accelerating high-stakes newsgathering, streamlining on-air scheduling logistics, and bridging design-to-engineering execution.
- Pioneered comprehensive AI-enablement initiatives (curating hands-on workshops and strategic office hours) that successfully fostered deep institutional adoption of agentic tools, driving measurable gains in cross-functional velocity and output quality.

EXPERIENCE

Director of AI Engineering

Jul 2025 - Present

NBCUniversal · New York, NY

- Direct comprehensive AI and agentic workflow strategies across the NBC News Group portfolio, establishing a unified vision for intelligent automation and GenAI adoption.
- Partner extensively with cross-functional leadership, including editorial, product, design, and engineering directors, to dramatically accelerate experimentation velocity and resolve day-to-day execution bottlenecks.

- Architect and deploy specialized custom agents designed to augment newsroom newsgathering capabilities, resulting in significantly enhanced scheduling efficiency for on-air producers and teams.
- Establish and lead robust AI-enablement programs, including regular office hours and hands-on technical workshops, empowering teams to confidently integrate agentic tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot, Cursor) into everyday production workflows.
- Steer technical architecture and strategic direction for AI-enabled discovery tools, deep personalization engines, and hybrid workflow systems leveraging React, Node.js, Python, and scalable cloud-native infrastructure (AWS/GCP).

Director of Engineering, NBC News Group Digital

Oct 2021 - Jul 2025

NBCUniversal · New York, NY

- Successfully built, mentored, and scaled high-performing engineering teams from the ground up, successfully hiring engineering managers and senior software engineers to drive the subscription business and broader digital portfolio.
- Spearheaded a critical architectural consolidation of live and short-form video player implementations, migrating 8 disparate media players down to 2 globally supported systems, eliminating platform fragmentation and slashing operational complexity.
- Orchestrated the sunsetting and secure retirement of a massive, monolithic legacy application, generating immediate overhead cost savings and reclaiming hundreds of engineering hours previously lost to routine maintenance.
- Championed an aggressive modernization initiative targeting web and mobile application performance, systematically migrating legacy codebases to React and TypeScript while enforcing strict CI/CD practices.
- Cultivated a healthy, inclusive engineering culture focused on psychological safety, resulting in exceptionally high retention rates, streamlined developer onboarding, and a culture of continuous learning.

Senior Engineering Manager

Sep 2015 - Oct 2021

CNBC · Englewood Cliffs, NJ

- Served as the primary technical lead for elite interactive and personalization initiatives across CNBC.com, delivering resilient, high-traffic features optimized for strict performance under intense market volatility.
- Designed and constructed bespoke subscription workflows and deeply integrated dynamic market-data visualization engines, directly contributing to substantial increases in daily user engagement and subscription conversion metrics.

- Collaborated tightly with product managers and UX/UI designers to develop rapid, high-fidelity coded prototypes that proved invaluable in shaping the long-term strategic direction of core editorial features.
- Established experimentation frameworks that allowed the business to execute reliable A/B testing on pivotal user flows with statistical confidence.
- Provided dedicated mentorship to junior and mid-level engineers, focusing heavily on scalable system architecture, creative problem-solving techniques, and rigorous front-end engineering standards.

Senior Interactive Designer

Jan 2007 - Sep 2015

CNBC · Englewood Cliffs, NJ

- Conceptualized, designed, and constructed award-winning interactive experiences, acting as a crucial hybrid bridge between visual design intent and rigorous technical implementation.
- Pioneered prototype-driven product discovery at CNBC, delivering exploratory web and iOS application interfaces that dramatically reduced engineering rework and validated user needs early in the product lifecycle.
- Solidified a deep, foundational expertise in advanced interaction design, CSS/JS animation, and rapid iterative development methodologies.
- Created design systems and UI component libraries that ensured visual consistency, accessibility compliance, and accelerated time-to-market for digital campaigns and news interactive features.

SKILLS

- AI engineering leadership
- Engineering management
- Org design
- Hiring & team building
- Product discovery
- Agentic AI & custom agents
- ChatGPT
- Gemini
- Cursor
- GitHub Copilot
- Microsoft Copilot Studio
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- React

- React Native
- Node.js
- Python
- Swift
- PHP
- GraphQL
- AWS & GCP
- Docker
- Design systems
- Coded prototyping
- Interaction design
- Experimentation frameworks
- CI/CD
- Figma

EDUCATION

Mount Ida College

Associate of Arts, Graphic Design

Katherine Gibbs School

Associate of Arts, Visual Communications
